

Every day, so many Middle and High schoolers enter through the front of DCI. While doing this, they pass by a green grass area in front of the school building.

“For better or for worse, emotionally charged visuals forge a more profound connection with the viewer, heightening the overall impact of the design.” - ([Gatesman Agency](#))

Overall, an area's visuals have a significant impact on the feelings it will evoke in viewers. Therefore, we want our own school and environment to have a nice aesthetic appeal, promoting positive emotions for all the students and staff who see it every day.

“While he [David Strayer] and other scientists may believe nature benefits our well-being, we live in a society where people spend more and more time indoors and online—especially children. Findings on how nature improves our brains bring added legitimacy to the call for preserving natural spaces—both urban and wild—and for spending more time in nature to lead healthier, happier, and more creative lives.” - ([Berkeley Edu](#))

Even though we have already addressed that we wanted to add some more aesthetics to our school, we weren't sure exactly how we were going to. After researching, it was apparent that nature specifically is a big source of relaxation and joy in humans, so since bringing these emotions to staff and students of DCI is really the whole point of the project, this is a key point of our design.

Therefore, to do this, we have decided to design the area using almost all natural features.

For example:

- Vibrant Flowers (Such as Carnations and Chrysanthemums)
- Bird Feeders
 - To attract some birds to the area
- Rock Path
 - Creating a way across the area while keeping its aesthetic

Therefore, the best way we found to improve this area in front of DCI while also providing students and staff a better start to their morning is to create a space filled with nature. Nature is proven to create happier, more relaxed emotions in people who are able to experience it, which is why we have chosen to focus on it. It will also give onlookers a better opinion of the school itself. So, we really want to decorate this “boring” area with nature while still keeping it aesthetically pleasing and nice to look at.